Clear Skies for Lucky Irish

The luck of the Irish appears to be with the Bay Area this weekend, with decreasing cloudiness today and clear skies forecast for Sunday, St. Patrick's Day.

What may be the last of several brief storms which have come in from the Pacific the last few days dumped .47 inches of rainfall in downtown Oakland this morning, beginning about 3 a.m.

The Weather Bureau forecast about 30 per cent chance of rain tonight and hardly any chance for rain tomorrow.

Clearing skies will be welcome to thousands of marchers and spectators expected to celebrate in San Francisco's annual St. Patrick's Day parade.

Some 240 units of marchers, Irish at least in spirit, will start the parade at 1:30 p.m. from Pipe and Montgomery Streets.

The parade route runs down Montgomery, right onto Post Street, left along Grant Avenue to O'Farrell Street and on to Polk Street where it will pass the City Hall reviewing stand.

WEEKEND ISSUE

TEEN PAGES

CHURCH NEWS

PREP SPORTS

Oakland Tribune

A RESPONSIBLE METROPOLITAN NEWSPAPER

95th YEAR, NO. 76 — SATURDAY, MARCH 16, 1968 — E★ — 10¢ DAILY, $2.75 A MONTH

Fiery Auto Collision Kills Girl

A 21-year-old Fremont woman burned to death early today when the car in which she was riding slammed into a Western Pacific freight train and burst into flames.

Mrs. Connie L. Shipman of 2878 Prune Ave. was helplessly trapped in the blazing wreckage and died before rescuers could come to her aid.

Richard E. Brownell, 26, of 1172 Prune Ave., thought by police to be the driver of the car, was thrown clear, but suffered second and third degree burns and head injuries. He was taken to Kaiser Hospital, Hayward, in serious condition.

Officer Chris Gershel said the couple was westbound on Prune Avenue at 3:05 a.m. when their auto drove onto the tracks and hit the moving westbound freight. Vincent Vallarino of Stockton was the engineer.

Gershel said the weather was clear and dry and both the wig-wag signal and warning lights were working at the railroad crossing.

Brownell is an employee of the General Motors plant at Fremont.

In Alameda, a motorcyclist was thrown to his death when he hit a parked car on Pacific Avenue just east of the Fourth Street intersection last night.

Police said Ronald C. Hatch, 25, of 263 Euclid Ave., Oakland, died in Highland Hospital after the collision at 11:30 p.m. There were no skid marks at the scene, indicating Hatch either did not see the car or misjudged his distance.

An 8-year-old Modesto girl was in critical condition today after she was knocked down by a car that then ran over her twice.

The driver, Clark Duarte, 57, said he was confused by the screams of the girl's mother and step-father, Mr. and Mrs. Gene Terril.

The California Highway Patrol said the child, Vicki Yartery, tried to cross the street Thursday when Duarte's car hit her.

The Terrils, who saw the accident, shouted to Duarte, who backed up over the fallen girl. The hysterical parents ran toward the car and Duarte drove forward, running over Vicki's head, the CHP said.

Terril picked her up and took her to a hospital.

The Highway Patrol said they have turned the case over to the Stanislaus County District Attorney's office for investigation.

Papal Ban On Masons Unchanged

VATICAN CITY (AP) — A Vatican communique today denied press reports that the Roman Catholic Church has changed or is considering a change in its opposition to Free Masonry.

The Vatican termed "groundless" reports that it was bypassing Canon law and allowing Catholic converts to keep their membership in Masonic organizations without incurring excommunication, the traditional penalty.

The reports began with news stories from Rome saying a group of Scandinavian bishops had quietly obtained a revocation of the ban on Free Masonry membership.

In Oslo, however, a Norwegian Roman Catholic spokesman said the Vatican had lifted the ban late in 1966. But he added that so far as he knew, the dispensation applied only to Norway, Denmark and Sweden.

Scandinavian bishops had argued to the Vatican that Masonic orders in Scandinavia, if not elsewhere were oriented to Christianity.

The communique apparently had no room for exceptions to the general rule included in the church code.

It implied, however, that there can be some changes in the present Vatican attitude to Masonic orders, presumably in the context of the church law reform now being studied.

Cathedral Robbed

CANTERBURY, England (AP) — Robbers broke into Canterbury Cathedral during the night and made off with church treasures worth several thousand dollars.

Airborne GIs Kill 128 Cong

SAIGON (UPI) — U.S. infantrymen landed from helicopters under cover of an artillery barrage today and killed 128 Viet Cong in a raid on a Communist-held village near Quang Ngai on South Vietnam's northern coast. The enemy toll in "operation resolved to win" near Saigon climbed to 484 dead.

Elements of the 11th Light Infantry Brigade dismounted from helicopters around My Lai village just after dawn and fought scattered bands of Communists until about 2 p.m., a spokesman at the American division headquarters in Chu Lai reported.

U.S. casualties were two killed and 10 wounded, a spokesman said.

Europeans Blame the War Costs

BRUSSELS (AP) — European concern over the Vietnam war's cost in money, as well as men, is seen here as a leading cause of the run on gold.

There is the basic fact that for 17 out of the past 18 years the United States has been shipping out more dollars and gold than it takes in, thus causing a deficit in the balance of payments.

This deficit stems from several causes including spending by Americans on travel and remittances to relatives abroad, foreign investment by U.S. firms, stationing of U.S. troops in Europe and U.S. imports of foreign goods. President Johnson has announced plans for plugging up many of the drains.

But many Europeans are fearful that the conflict in Vietnam will be much more difficult to plug.

"If they would only announce in Washington tomorrow that they are deescalating the war, that might make all the difference," said a Brussels banker.

An economist who works here on Common Market matters said: "Any way of ending the war would have a good effect on the monetary situation. It would be fine if Hanoi made an acceptable offer. But

Continued on Page 3, Col. 1

Gold Pool Hint: U.S. Austerity

By STERLING F. GREEN

WASHINGTON (AP) — America's six allies in the London gold pool converged on Washington today for a two-day conference seeking to solve the gravest global monetary crisis 10-40 years.

As the central bankers assembled, a congressional drive developed to force a greater fiscal austerity on this country — and thus to generate, it was hoped, greater confidence in the dollar.

At the same time, President Johnson asked for new budget cuts coupled with his tax hike. An Administration spokesman talked in terms of an income surtax that would yield about $9 billion, to be matched by budget cuts of equal size.

Later, Johnson flew to his Texas ranch. He is expected to remain there at least through Tuesday, which is his daughter Lynda Bird's 24th birthday.

The President's austerity move reportedly had the approval of Rep. Wilbur D. Mills, D-Ark., the potent chairman of the House Ways and Means Committee.

Mills has admitted nothing publicly but is known to have conferred at length with Chairman George H. Mahon, D-Tex., of the House Appropriations Committee. Mahon favors the double-edged plan.

But it remained to be seen whether those moves, buttressing the secret seven-power talks in the mausoleum-like Federal Reserve Board building, would dissuade profit-hungry gold speculators from resuming next week their frantic assault on the dollar in the world's gold markets.

The crisis was generally regarded as the most severe since the stock market collapse of 1929.

Airtight security was assured for the weekend conference of the central bankers of the United States, Britain, Belgium, Germany, Italy, the Netherlands and Switzerland.

Congressional leaders echoed official assurances the $35-an-ounce price for gold will be maintained. Chairman John Sparkman, D-Ala., of the Senate Banking Committee predicted "it will be the speculators who suffer the greatest injury."

American officials made no predictions on the outcome of the seven-power conference, in which the governor of the Bank of International Settlements at Basel, Switzerland, will join the seven central bankers.

But the West German government has issued a stand-by price plan for gold. The rate

Continued on Page 3, Col. 2

Hughes Wants 6 Vegas Hotels

CARSON CITY, Nev.—(UPI) Industrialist Howard Hughes has sent word to Nevada state officials that he'll settle for ownership of six hotels on the Las Vegas Strip.

The unpredictable billionaire already has spent $125 million in Las Vegas to purchase four plush casinos and announced plans for a new 4,000 room luxury hotel. Now he is seeking to add the 1,500 room Stardust Hotel and the nearby Silver Slipper to his collection.

Robert Maheu, Hughes's top Nevada executive, told the state gaming policy board that if granted the right for these purchases "we would have no further interest in acquiring major hotel properties in Las Vegas."

Kennedy Leaps Into Race for President

AS SEN. ROBERT KENNEDY TALKS POLITICS TWO OF HIS SONS PLAY
Mrs. Kennedy keeps amused eye on Christopher, 4, teasing Matthew, 2.—(AP)

Johnson Policies Attacked

WASHINGTON (AP) — Sen. Robert F. Kennedy, D-N.Y., jumped into the Democratic presidential contest today with an offer to cooperate with Sen. Eugene J. McCarthy, D-Minn., to wrest the nomination from President Johnson.

After listening to Kennedy's statement at a televised news conference that "I believe I can win," McCarthy said in a Wisconsin broadcast, "I'm the best potential candidate in the field."

Kennedy charged into competition for convention votes with the assertion that the country is on a "perilous course." He said he is willing to work with McCarthy, another war critic, to spur a national debate on Vietnam policies.

But McCarthy was chilly to the kind of cooperative effort he seemed to suspect was primarily designed on Kennedy's part to take over for himself the anti-Johnson delegates to the convention.

Kennedy promised to support McCarthy where he himself could not run. McCarthy said he "could have used some help in New Hampshire and kind of waited around for it." He ran strongly against Johnson in last Tuesday's primary there.

While his two opponents sparred edgily at long range, Johnson bantered lightly about the whole affair.

Speaking at a businessmen's conference headed by Henry Ford II, Johnson said: "These are the days when we have to take chances . . . some speculate in gold — a primary metal — and others just speculate in primaries . . .

Kennedy said his entry against Johnson, the man chosen by his assassinated brother, was not in opposition to

Continued on Page 2, Col. 5

McCarthy Will Be Supported by CDC

Compiled from AP and UPI

ANAHEIM — Sen. Eugene J. McCarthy today had a pledge of "total, active" support from California's largest Democratic volunteer group.

It was planned to serve as a blunt warning to Sen. Robert F. Kennedy from the liberal California Democratic Council that he could not expect the group's active backing in the California primary.

Gerald N. Hill, the council's young president and cochairman of McCarthy's California campaign organization, predicted Kennedy would finish third on the June 4 primary ballot — behind President Johnson and McCarthy.

"We feel very strongly that Senator Kennedy's entry into California is potentially divisive," Hill told newsmen shortly after the delegates to the CDC's statewide convention had approved a resolution endorsing McCarthy.

The vote was moved up from today after council officials heard that Kennedy planned to announce his candidacy today.

Some delegates to the convention of the 30,000 - member CDC booed a Kennedy backer as they adopted the resolution pledging their support to McCarthy and his peace campaign.

"We have to make sure Lyndon Baines Johnson will not be nominated at the Democratic National Convention," said Elijah Turner of Oakland. "The way to do that is to give Eugene McCarthy the vote."

But Mrs. Julie Fisher of San Diego said Kennedy "probably would be a better President." Some of the audience booed.

The top - heavy voice vote for the endorsement gives McCarthy the support of the council's grass - roots workers in the June 4 primary.

But their action isn't expected to deter the efforts of Kennedy's California campaigners, led by the speaker of the assembly, Jesse M. Unruh.

Kennedy is also critical of the war and privately delegates expressed fear that the New York senator and McCarthy will split the anti - administration vote, giving the state's 174 convention votes to a state backing President Johnson and his Vietnam policy.

A few of the delegates urged the convention to go slow in backing McCarthy. And Martin Shone, McCarthy's co - chairman in California, cautioned his fellow campaigners against "bitterness toward the Kennedy candidacy."

The McCarthy resolution spells out the council's "dedication to an immediate end to the conflict in Vietnam; the total elimination of racism in America and the progressive creation of an equal society in the United States."

Car Kills Girl, 4

PARADISE (UPI) — Lenice Jacobson, 4, Paradise, was killed yesterday when the apparently wandered into the path of a car driven by Dorthy J. Anderson, 34, Paradise, on North Libby Road here, the highway patrol reported.

'Bobby-O' Marches In Parade

NEW YORK (UPI) — In his first presidential campaign appearance today, Sen. Robert F. Kennedy stole the show at the annual St. Patrick's Day parade.

Sporting two "Bobby" buttons, he marched up Fifth Avenue with 125,000 other real and adopted Irishmen to the cheers of thousands lining the street.

"I'm delighted to see so many friends here, and I'm sorry I'm late," Kennedy told a gathering of 200 newsmen at a midtown restaurant after his return from Washington.

The New York senator each year hosts a breakfast for political reporters at the restaurant, Charley O's.

Coatless and hatless, Kennedy put two green and white buttons reading "Bobby-O" in his lapel and joined the parade, hundreds of cheering New Yorkers falling in behind him.

Uptown, at the reviewing stand, Republican Gov. Nelson A. Rockefeller, who has yet to announce his presidential aspirations, "filed newsmen Kennedy's decision to run was "a personal decision expressed with deep feeling."

Moon Craft Ready

CAPE KENNEDY (UPI) — The U.S. Space Agency today confirmed that its four-legged moon landing Apollo spacecraft is ready for a manned flight in earth orbit next fall without a second unmanned test.

Ship Hits Oil Barges, 11 Die In Inferno

POINTE A LA HACHE, La. (AP)—The cargo ship African Star was engulfed by flames that killed eleven crewmen and injured at least 36 others early today after a hundred-mile collision with two oil barges on the lower Mississippi River, the Coast Guard reported.

"We're going to need some help here with the bodies," a Coast Guard official radioed from the beached and burning ship. "There are quite a few of them." He gave the figure of dead as 11 eleven.

An eyewitness said some of the 39 persons on board the ship leaped into the river as the blazing vessel ground ashore on the west bank. They made their way to the safety of the levee.

Flames shot up 100 feet as the burning barges drifted downstream. Blazing oil spread across the water.

GOING HOME—Dentist Philip Blaiberg (left), the world's only surviving heart transplant patient, looks fit and happy as he leaves Groote Schuur Hospital in South Africa today. He smiles farewell to nurse and Dr. Christiaan Barnard, who performed the operation 74 days ago.—(AP)